

**Take Your PowerPoint With You**

Working on a colleague or friend's PC? You don't need to waste time tweaking PowerPoint preferences to get everything the way you want it—all your PowerPoint settings are in this file:

C:\Documents and Settings\[username]\Application Data\Microsoft\PowerPoint\PPt\#.pcb
(where ## is the PowerPoint version number you have installed.)

Simply carry this file around and place it in the same folder on the new machine, and now PowerPoint is just the way you like it! Do remember to back up your friend's settings file, though!

**Advanced Filtering**

If you want your presentation to have a "background score" from an audio CD, go to **Insert > Movies and Sounds > Play CD Audio Track**. Select 'Hide Sound Icon', and click OK. When PowerPoint asks you whether you want the music to start automatically or when clicked, choose **Automatically**.

**The Function Keys in PowerPoint**

[F1] [Shift] + [F1]	Bring up Office Help or the Office Assistant Bring up context-sensitive help
[F2]	Select the text, or text within a text box
[Alt] + [F2]	Save As
[Shift] + [F3]	Change the case of selected characters. (From caps to small and vice versa)
[F4]	Repeat the last action
[Shift] + [F4]	Repeat the last Find action to Find next
[Ctrl] + [F4]	Close current presentation
[Alt] + [F4]	Quit PowerPoint
[F5]	Start the presentation in a slide show
[Ctrl] + [F5]	Restore the Presentation window
[Alt] + [F5]	Restore the PowerPoint window
[F6]	Move clockwise to the next pane
[Shift] + [F6]	Move anticlockwise to the next pane
[Ctrl] + [F6]	Move clockwise to the next presentation
[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [F6]	Move anti-clockwise to the next presentation
[F7]	Run the spell checker
[Alt] + [F7]	Next misspelling with automatic spell checking enabled
[Ctrl] + [F10]	Activate the main menu bar (Same as the [Alt] key)
[Alt] + [F10]	Maximise the presentation window
[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [F10]	Maximise the PowerPoint window
[Alt] + [F11]	Display Visual Basic code (if any) in the presentation
[F12]	Save As...
[Shift] + [F12]	Save
[Ctrl] + [F12]	Open...
[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [F12]	Print

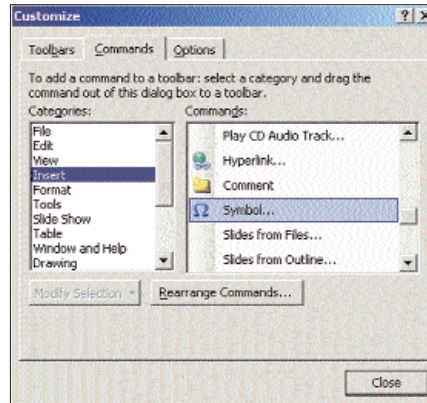
**PPS? PPT? PPBoth?**

You can save your presentation as a PowerPoint Show (.pps) if you want the slideshow to start as soon as you open the file. But if you want to edit some parts of the show in PowerPoint, all you need to do is rename the file with the .ppt extension. Windows will warn you that the file might become unusable—ignore this. It even works vice-versa—if you rename a .ppt to .pps, the presentation now starts in a full-screen slide show instead of opening PowerPoint for editing.

**Symbols In Your Toolbar**

If you often create presentations with characters such as "± © ® ™ ½ ÷", or the other assortment of symbols your fonts offer, you should have them quickly accessible on the PowerPoint Toolbar.

Go to **Tools > Customize > Commands**. In the list on the left, click on **Insert** and scroll down the list on the right till you find 'Symbol...' (there's a blue Omega symbol next to it). Click and drag this to any toolbar you like and click Close.

**Add symbols to your toolbar**

So the next time you want a symbol, just use this button to quickly insert all those weird characters into your text.

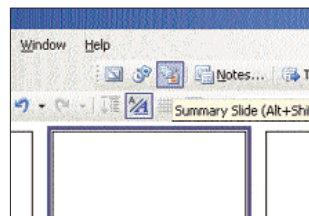
**Cycle Through Objects**

If you have loads of overlapping objects on a PowerPoint slide, it can be difficult to select the object you want to work with. Instead of clicking to select objects, use the [Tab] key instead.

When you press [Tab], PowerPoint selects the first object on the slide. Every time you press [Tab] after that, it selects the next object, so you can easily cycle through the objects on your slide by repeatedly pressing [Tab]. If you overshoot the mark and miss the object you were after, hold down [Shift] while you press [Tab] to reverse direction and select the previous object.

**Summary Slides**

Creating slides that summarise your presentations is easy: in PowerPoint, Go to **View > Slide Sorter** to see miniatures of all your slides. Hold down [Ctrl] and click on the slides you want to include in the summary, and click on the 'Summary Slide' button. The

**Summarise your slides**

summary slide now contains the titles of all the pages you selected.

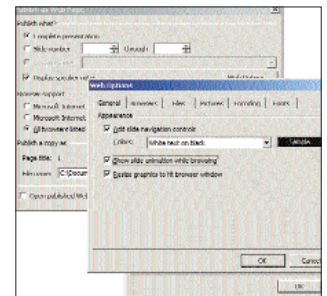
**Use Slide Masters For Consistency**

Start with the Slide Master (Go to **View > Master > Slide Master**) to set up the layout for your slides and create a consistent look.

Format the background, specify colours, select fonts and bullets, add text animation and logos, and insert slide numbers or other elements which you want to repeat for all slides.

**Presentations On The Web**

To publish your presentations for the Web, go to **File > Save as Web Page**. In the dialog that appears, just clicking **Save** will save your presentation so that it can be opened again in PowerPoint and edited. You can also click

**Save your presentation for the Web**

Publish for some more saving options—if you want your transitions and animations to appear on your Web presentation, click on **Web Options** and check the box that says 'Show slide animations while browsing'.

**Remove The Ugly White Shadow**

If you've turned on the Text Shadow option (the 'S' on the Formatting Toolbar), you will notice that the shadow turns a horrifying white when you make the background black. Fool the human eye—when you select a background colour, choose a custom